

BROOKE HOGAN

Merchandise Assistant | Item Setup & Data Management | Category Strategy | Pricing Execution
Brooke_Hogan2@baylor.edu | 949-397-0735 | linkedin.com/in/brookechogan | Dallas, TX

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Apparel Merchandising senior with hands-on experience in item setup, product data management, assortment support, and purchase order tracking. Proficient in retail POS systems, Microsoft Excel, and cross-functional coordination across category strategy, pricing strategies, and seasonal planning. Strong accuracy and organizational skills with a track record of meeting tight deadlines across fast-paced retail and creative environments.

EDUCATION

Baylor University | Waco, TX *Expected May 2026*
B.S. Apparel Merchandising | Minor: Entrepreneurship & Corporate Innovation | Dean's List: Fall 2024, Spring 2025

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Sales & Management Intern | The Buckle *May - Aug 2025 | Waco, TX*

- Led a 5-week SKU-level merchandising analysis on men's graphic tees, synthesizing six weeks of sales data to develop category strategy recommendations, inform product strategy decisions, and drive sell-through and margin goals
- Completed 240+ hours of management training under Area Manager covering inventory flow, purchase order tracking, retail POS systems operation, pricing strategies, and vendor coordination; trained new associates on brand standards
- Generated \$13K+ in weekly sales with \$186 average transaction and 3+ UPT through hands-on product expertise and POS-driven transaction management

Sales Associate, Designer Women's Apparel | Nordstrom *May 2024 - Jan 2025 | Mission Viejo, CA*

- Achieved 120% of monthly sales targets and ranked top 5% of department; processed all transactions through retail POS systems while maintaining pricing accuracy and supporting seasonal markdown execution
- Partnered with visual and marketing teams to execute trend-aligned displays driving a 20% increase in display-driven sales; applied trend analysis to connect product storytelling to sales results

Head Chair, Event Planning | Apparel Professionals Club, Baylor University *Nov 2024 - Present | Waco, TX*

- Coordinated 3 industry panels and 2 large-scale events (80+ attendees each), managing vendor outreach, marketing materials, timelines, and documentation across an 8-person committee
- Prepared financial reports on event expenses and supply orders; maintained accurate records and presented data-driven recaps to club leadership using Microsoft Excel and POS-equivalent tracking tools

Sales Associate & Visual Merchandiser | Follett, Baylor University Bookstore *Jan 2026 - Present | Waco, TX*

- Support daily floor operations, inventory management, visual merchandising, and POS transactions in a high-traffic campus retail environment while balancing full-time coursework

FEATURED ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Five Below Buying Analysis - NYC Beauty Category Assortment Plan *Aug - Dec 2025*
Advanced Buying Course, Baylor University

- Developed a 6-month category strategy and financial plan analyzing Q2 sales data across 1,858 stores; built a comprehensive Excel assortment matrix with pricing strategies, a 13% markdown plan, and receipt timing aligned to vendor lead times
- Delivered SKU-level product strategy recommendations on price point representation and new item introductions; prepared financial reports covering projected sales, margin, and inventory metrics against Dollar Tree and Dollar General benchmarks

Ruth & Naomi E-Commerce Site Redesign *Aug - Dec 2025*
Digital Retail Strategies Course, Baylor University

- Led end-to-end digital merchandising redesign with customer A/B testing, optimizing item setup, product taxonomy, and category strategy to improve discovery, conversion, and data management accuracy
- Delivered a 5-point implementation plan covering pricing display, SKU attribute setup, and on-site execution; applied product strategy principles to align digital assortment with omnichannel goals

SKILLS & TOOLS

Merchandising & Data: Item setup, product data management, category strategy, product strategy, assortment support, purchase order tracking, pricing strategies, promotional and markdown execution, trend analysis, seasonal assortment planning, preparing financial reports, documentation

Cross-Functional & Tools: Vendor coordination, marketing and visual partnership, effective communication, teamwork, accuracy, organizational skills; Microsoft Excel (assortment matrices, pivot tables, data entry), retail POS systems, Word, PowerPoint, Google Workspace, Adobe Creative Suite